MC 501 Definitions Practice rubric

25 points. Due Monday, October 19, 11:59 PM.

How this is scored. Add the points from each row; the total is out of 25. A first attempt is graded forgivingly: a part that is there but incomplete earns partial credit, and 0 is kept for a part that is missing. Attempts are unlimited, so you can revise an early submission right up to the deadline.

- Each row looks across all of your variables. Four variables done fully is the assignment.

Definitions Practice, 25 points

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Conceptual definition, with its source 3 points	**3 points.** Every variable says what it means in the abstract and cites where the idea comes from; an idea you invented gets a sentence defending it.	**2 points.** Defined for every variable, but a citation is missing, or an invented idea goes undefended.	**1 point.** Some definitions missing, or definitions that list examples instead of saying what the variable captures.	**0 points.** Missing.
Operational definition 6 points	**6 points.** Every variable says exactly what a coder does to assign a value, with an action a coder performs, clear enough that a stranger could follow it and reach your answer.	**5 points.** A procedure for every variable, but one leaves a step to the coder's judgment.	**3 to 4 points.** At least one repeats the conceptual definition in other words, the mistake this assignment exists to catch. If it has no action a coder performs, it is not an operational definition yet.	**0 to 2 points.** No procedures.

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Level of measurement, and what it allows 3 points	**3 points.** Named for every variable, with one sentence on what it allows and rules out in analysis (for example, no mean of a nominal variable).	**2 points.** Named for every variable, but the sentence on what it allows is missing or wrong for one.	**1 point.** Named for some variables only.	**0 points.** Missing.
Coded values 3 points	**3 points.** Every value is listed with what it means, and every item fits exactly one value.	**2 points.** Listed with meanings, but there is no place for items that fit none of them, or two values overlap.	**1 point.** Values listed without meanings, or the list trails off ("etc.").	**0 points.** Missing.
Edge-case decision rules 5 points	**5 points.** At least two per variable, each a rule a coder can apply, drawn from cases that come up in your material.	**4 points.** Two per variable, but one is an intention ("be careful with sarcasm") instead of a rule.	**3 points.** Fewer than two for some variables.	**0 to 2 points.** None, or intentions only.
Validity sentence 5 points	**5 points.** One sentence per variable naming what would make you doubt it measures the idea in its conceptual definition, specific to that variable.	**4 points.** Present for every variable, but the same general sentence is reused.	**3 points.** Present for some variables only.	**0 to 2 points.** Missing.